PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director-level Platform Engineering leader with 20+ years delivering enterprise-scale platform and SRE programs for US FinTech companies from India. Specialist in standing up multi-squad platform teams from zero - Azure-native infrastructure, Kubernetes, API-first shared services, CI/CD orchestration, and data platform governance. Proven track record scaling engineering organizations from 4 to 40 engineers across ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC - with direct VP and C-suite accountability. Built Platform Engineering delivery functions from ground up in a single quarter; delivered 200+ builds/hour through API-first deployment platforms; reduced MTTR 40%+ through AIOps and automated remediation. Deep cross-geography leadership partnering with US-based teams at enterprise scale.

CORE COMPETENCIES

GCC Platform Engineering Leadership | Multi-Squad Team Building (40+ Engineers) | Azure Cloud-Native Architecture | Kubernetes & Container Orchestration | CI/CD & Deployment Engineering | DevSecOps Excellence | SLO/SLI & Observability Engineering | India-US Cross-Geography Collaboration | AI-Driven Engineering Practices | FinTech Domain (ADP, Schwab, BMO, RBC) | Talent Development & Apprenticeship Culture

WORK EXPERIENCE

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 - Present

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

- **Platform Engineering Build-Out (Charles Schwab):** Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up as IRIS's India-side delivery lead - established foundational SRE practices, API release gates, reliability SLOs, incident governance, and on-call runbooks. Delivered 99.9% release reliability and aligned cross-platform artifact deployment as part of the TD Ameritrade merger integration programme.
- **High-Throughput Deployment Platform (modeas):** Architected and delivered a deployment orchestration platform serving all product domains - 200+ builds/deployments per hour, containerized via Kubernetes and Helm, IaC-driven. Eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually; accelerated deployment cadence by 600%.
- **Multi-Squad SRE Scale-Up (ADP):** Scaled ADP's SRE organization from 4 to 40 engineers and architects across India, Canada, and the US. Defined SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets across multi-client cloud platforms; instituted blameless postmortem culture and AIOps-driven automated remediation via Dynatrace and Ansible - reducing MTTR by 40%+.
- **Cloud Migration & FinOps (BMO):** Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS migration for BMO CCB; delivered CDK-enabled deployment pipelines across ECS Fargate and Lambda with HA/DR built in. Drove FinOps practices, rightsizing workloads and reducing cloud waste across the AWS estate.
- **GenAI & Data Platform (BMO):** Designed and deployed GenAI risk summarisation and Q&A assistants on AWS Bedrock using BCRG/LTS event-driven pipelines - reducing manual analysis effort and accelerating regulatory insights delivery.
- **DevSecOps & Engineering Standards:** Deployed Prometheus and Grafana alongside Dynatrace for full-stack observability across ADP's platform. Established Chaos Engineering practices using Keptn; implemented ITIL-aligned incident, problem, and change management across three major banking clients.
- Conducted quarterly enterprise-wide training sessions for up to 200 participants per 20-hour session; recognised as IRIS Certified Trainer for Q2 & Q3 2024.

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist | Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

- **Enterprise CI/CD & Platform Governance:** Designed and delivered the Robo Deployment Framework - a PowerShell-native CI/CD orchestration platform enabling self-service release pipelines for Windows services, database deployments (SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server), and enterprise application workloads. Reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction) across 250+ applications and 60+ teams.
- **Java/Spring Boot Platform Oversight:** Governed end-to-end CI/CD and release engineering for 250+ Java-based and multi-stack applications at RBC - integrating SonarQube, Jenkins, UrbanCode, JFrog Artifactory, and GitHub into a unified DevSecOps pipeline with SAST/DAST/IAST scanning and SOX/GDPR compliance gates.
- Inducted the DORA framework across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance using Azure DevOps - establishing Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics.
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub, enabling modern CI/CD and self-service provisioning at scale. Contributed to ~$200K in new project acquisitions through pre-sales and delivery leadership.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018

Automation Architect | Toronto, Canada (Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets)

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using Kubernetes and Helm - enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery - automating 80+ applications and 250+ components across heterogeneous stacks (Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, Mainframe).
- Contributed to closure of a $478K Statement of Work for a DevOps engagement (12-member team, 18-month delivery). Enabled $180K Capital Markets engagement through a JCL Mainframe automation pilot at RBC Wealth Management.

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd.

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017

Technology Manager | Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

- Led end-to-end data and code migration from Informatica to SQL Server 2012 for Adobe, covering schema redesign, ETL re-engineering, and data validation at enterprise scale.
- Architected and delivered zero-downtime business application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned the full plan, execution, and cutover, ensuring continuity across all production workloads.
- Led SAP HANA upgrades and platform modernisation; directed cross-functional global engineering teams on large-scale enterprise delivery programmes.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014

Sr. SDET - QA, Automation & Production Engineering | India

- Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner: accountable for the complete quality and operational lifecycle of Sales & Marketing applications serving tens of thousands of users across US, EMEA, and APAC - achieving sustained 99.99% uptime over a 7-year tenure.
- Built and led QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines; managed production operations end-to-end including incident response, RCA, and infrastructure administration (Windows/Linux).
- Modernised marketing platforms through cloud migration and self-healing architectures, supporting 200% user growth with no degradation in platform reliability.

KEY PLATFORM INITIATIVES

modeas - High-Throughput Deployment Orchestration Platform

Azure | Kubernetes | Helm | CI/CD

Built shared deployment platform serving all product domains: 200+ builds/deployments per hour, self-service pipelines, containerized via Kubernetes/Helm. Eliminated 10,000+ manual hours annually; 600% deployment cadence improvement.

Charles Schwab Platform Engineering - Greenfield Delivery

Team Building | SRE | Merger Integration

Built 18-member Platform Engineering team from zero as IRIS India-side delivery lead (post TD Ameritrade merger). Established SLO governance, API release gates, incident management, and on-call framework. Delivered 99.9% release reliability; aligned cross-platform artifact deployment across merged Schwab/Ameritrade environments.

BMO GenAI Risk Platform - AWS Bedrock

GenAI | Event-Driven | AWS Bedrock

Designed and deployed GenAI risk summarisation and interactive Q&A assistants using event-driven BCRG/LTS pipelines on AWS Bedrock. Reduced manual regulatory analysis effort and accelerated insights delivery for BMO risk teams.

Robo Deployment Framework - RBC (250+ Apps, 60+ Teams)

CI/CD | Java Platform Governance | DevSecOps

Self-service CI/CD orchestration platform governing Java and multi-stack deployments across RBC Insurance. Application onboarding reduced from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction). SOX/GDPR-compliant change evidence pipeline integrated with SonarQube, JFrog, and GitHub.

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence - Woolf University 2024

General Management Program (GMP) - ISB Hyderabad 2022

M.Sc in Computer Science - Osmania University 2002

B.Sc in Electronics - Kakatiya University 2000

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) 2026

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) 2025

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (SAA-C01) 2026

Google Cloud Certified - Professional Cloud Architect (PCA) 2026

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)

ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Platform: Azure (AZ-305), AWS, GCP, Kubernetes (CKAD), Docker, Helm, Terraform, AWS CDK, Ansible, Azure DevOps

Platform Engineering: API-first architecture, Microservices governance, IaC, Self-healing systems, CI/CD orchestration, Developer experience, Service-oriented design

Data & Integration: SAP HANA, SQL Server, Oracle, SSIS, AWS Bedrock event-driven pipelines, Kafka integration, Tableau, Power BI

Observability & AIOps: Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, MS Application Insights, AppDynamics, Splunk, Telegraf

Reliability Engineering: SLIs/SLOs, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Self-Healing Frameworks, ITIL, ServiceNow, Blameless Postmortems

DevSecOps: SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, SAST/DAST/IAST, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, UrbanCode, shift-left security

Languages & Automation: Python, Go, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy, C#.Net; Java/Spring Boot platform governance (RBC 250+ apps, ADP microservices fleet)

AI/ML: GenAI (AWS Bedrock, Azure AI), AIOps, MLOps; MSc in Artificial Intelligence; AI-102, DP-100